Aakansha Jain

Department of Economics, Iowa State University, Ames, IA

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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Iowa State University, USA — May 2027 (expected)
M.Sc. in Economics, Shiv Nadar University, India — 2020
B.Sc. in Economics, University of Calcutta, India — 2017
(Minor: Mathematics & Statistics; First-Class Honours)

Fields of Interest

Labor Economics, Agricultural Labor, Development Economics, Rural Development, Economics of Education, Migration, Applied Microeconomics

Job Market Paper

"The Rise of H-2A: Causal Evidence on Guestworker Substitution for Settled Farm Labor"
solo-authored

Publications

Manternach, R., **Jain, A.**, Orazem, P.F., & Soborowicz, L. (2025). "Are College Towns Really Recession Proof?" *Growth and Change*, 56(4): e70064.

Jain, A., Montenegro, C., & Orazem, P.F. (forthcoming, 2026). "Youth Labor Markets in High- and Low-Income Countries." In K. Leicht (Ed.), *The Oxford Handbook of the 21st Century Economy and Society*. Oxford University Press.

Working Papers and Works in Progress

- "Returns to Farming with Controls for Farming Entry" (with I. Cho and P.F. Orazem; under review)
- "College Wage Premiums in India: Trends and Spatial Decomposition, 1987–2012" (solo-authored)
- "An Overview of the 2024 Iowa State University Alumni Survey" (with A. Andrade, J. Eyles, K. Kimle, P.F. Orazem, and R. Unal)
- "Does Broadband Close the Rural Education Gap?" (with L. Han and J.V. Winters)
- "Firm Entry and Serial Entrepreneurship Among Iowa State Alumni" (with D. Lin and P.F. Orazem)

Policy and Outreach Publications

- **Jain, A.**, & Chandio, R. (2026). "H-2A Compensation in Iowa: Trends, Policies, and Takeaways." *Ag Decision Maker*, Iowa State University Extension and Outreach.
- **Jain, A.**, Lin, D., & Orazem, P.F. (forthcoming, Nov 2026). "Graduating in a Downturn: Business Cycles and Entrepreneurship Among Iowa State Graduates." *Agricultural Policy Review*.
- **Jain, A.**, & Chandio, R. (forthcoming, Nov 2026). "Who Hires H-2A Workers in Iowa, and for What?" *Agricultural Policy Review*.
- Crespi, G., & **Jain, A.** (2026). "Where Do They Go? Migration Patterns of Iowa State University Alumni." *Agricultural Policy Review*. Covered by *Axios Des Moines*.
- Andrade, A., Eyles, J., **Jain, A.**, Kimle, K., Orazem, P.F., & Unal, R. (2025). "How a Land Grant College Affects Business and Job Creation." *Agricultural Policy Review*.

Conferences and Presentations

- "The Rise of H-2A" (job market paper). Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting, Houston, TX, November 2026; Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA) South Asia Section Graduate Student Symposium (virtual), October 2026; AAEA Annual Meeting, Kansas City, MO, July 2026.

- "Mapping the Missing Market Pathways in U.S. Dairy Regions" (with A. Basha and H. Lee). Data Visualization Challenge, AAEA Annual Meeting, Kansas City, MO, July 2026; invited talk, USDA Agricultural Marketing Service FAME 2.0 Release Webinar (virtual), October 2026.
- "Are College Towns Really Recession Proof?" (with R. Manternach, P.F. Orazem, and L. Soborowicz; presented by A. Jain). Midwest Economics Association Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL, March 2025.

Honors and Awards

Selected Paper ($200 award), Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA) South Asia Section Graduate Student Symposium 2026

First Place, USDA Agricultural Marketing Service and AAEA Local Food Economics Data Visualization Challenge (with A. Basha and H. Lee) 2026

- $1,200 first-place team prize and $1,200 in AAEA travel support

Research Experience

Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Iowa State University — Spring 2024 – Present
Research Assistant, Indian School of Business, Hyderabad, India — Summer 2022
Research Assistant, IFMR LEAD (development research center), India — Aug 2021 – Mar 2022
Research Assistant, King's College London (project based in India) — Jun 2020 – Jul 2021

Teaching

Instructor of Record, ECON 3530: Money, Banking, and Financial Institutions — Spring 2025
Teaching Assistant, Iowa State University — Fall 2022 – Spring 2026

- ECON 1010: Principles of Microeconomics; ECON 1020: Principles of Macroeconomics; ECON 2070: Quantitative Methods in Economic Analysis I; ECON 3530: Money, Banking, and Financial Institutions

Teaching Assistant, Shiv Nadar University, India — Fall 2018 – Spring 2021

- Econometrics (graduate course); Logic and Scientific Methods (undergraduate course)

Professional Service

Referee: *Growth and Change* (2025); *Journal of Development Effectiveness* (2025)
Discussant: SEA Annual Meeting (2026); AAEA South Asia Section Graduate Student Symposium (2026); Midwest Economics Association Annual Meeting (2025)
Session Moderator: AAEA Annual Meeting (2026)
Iowa State University: Elected Chair, College of Liberal Arts and Sciences, and Senator, Department of Economics, Graduate & Professional Student Senate (2023 – 2024)

Skills

Software: Stata, Python, LaTeX
Restricted Data: Special Sworn Status, U.S. Census Bureau; Federal Statistical Research Data Center project No. 3044 (restricted American Community Survey and Numident microdata)
Additional Training: Machine Learning: A Signal Processing Perspective (EE 425)
Languages: English (fluent), Hindi (native)

References

- **Dr. John V. Winters**, Professor and Co-Major Advisor, Iowa State University. winters1@iastate.edu, 515-294-6263
- **Dr. Peter F. Orazem**, University Professor Emeritus, Interim Department Chair, and Co-Major Advisor, Iowa State University. pfo@iastate.edu, 515-294-8656
- **Dr. Amani Elobeid**, Teaching Professor, Iowa State University. amani@iastate.edu, 515-294-8122
- **Dr. Rabail Chandio**, Assistant Professor and Extension Economist, Iowa State University. rchandio@iastate.edu, 515-294-6181